perplexity

Problem statement: StaySmart

StaySmart is a daily "mental gym" designed to help people preserve and practise independent reasoning in an AI-assisted world. As generative AI makes answers, summaries, recommendations, and decisions available instantly, people may increasingly skip the effortful stages of thinking: framing a problem, generating alternatives, checking assumptions, and defending a conclusion. This is a form of *cognitive offloading*—delegating mental work to a tool—which can be useful when intentional, but risky when it becomes automatic. Research with knowledge workers finds that greater confidence in GenAI is associated with less critical-thinking effort, while confidence in one's own ability is associated with more effort.[1]

The user problem

People do not necessarily become "less intelligent" because they use AI. The deeper problem is **reduced practice of reasoning**. When AI supplies the first draft, explanation, comparison, or recommendation before a person has tried, the user can become an editor of an answer rather than the owner of the thinking process. Research has reported an association between frequent AI-tool use, cognitive offloading, and lower measured critical-thinking performance; this is evidence of a risk and correlation, not proof that every instance of AI use causes decline.[2]

This matters especially in work and everyday decisions, where the valuable human skills are not only finding an answer but also:

- Defining the real problem before solving it.
- Spotting weak evidence, hidden assumptions, and bias.
- Comparing trade-offs when there is no single correct answer.
- Reasoning under uncertainty.
- Explaining and defending a decision clearly.

For analytics professionals, for example, an AI-generated "best model" recommendation is not enough; the person still needs to question data quality, leakage, fairness, business cost, validation design, and whether the model solves the right business problem.

Product opportunity

LinkedIn's games demonstrate demand for brief, repeatable, thinking-oriented daily activities: its current game experiences centre on logic, pattern recognition, vocabulary, and puzzles designed to be completed in minutes. However, classic puzzles alone mainly train puzzle performance. **StaySmart should differentiate itself by practising transferable decision skills**: reasoning, estimation, interpretation, argument evaluation, and AI-output verification.[3]

> **StaySmart helps people use AI without outsourcing their judgment.**
> It turns short daily moments into active practice: *think first, commit to a reason, then compare with AI feedback.*

Proposed product definition

StaySmart is a web-first mental fitness app that delivers one short daily challenge, typically 3–7 minutes, before offering hints or AI support. The aim is not to ban AI; it is to build a healthier habit: **attempt → explain → review → improve**.

Core design principle: AI comes second

1. Present a realistic challenge without an answer.
2. Ask the user to choose an approach or write a brief rationale.
3. Allow a limited hint only after an attempt.
4. Reveal alternative reasoning paths and common errors.
5. Give feedback on the *quality of reasoning*, not only whether the final answer was correct.
6. Track improvement by skill area over time.

This responds directly to a key finding from workplace research: when AI performs more of the task, human critical thinking can shift toward verification, integration, and oversight. StaySmart can deliberately practise those skills instead of letting them disappear. [1]

Initial challenge categories

- **Logic and constraint puzzles:** Grid, sequence, and path challenges inspired by the appeal of LinkedIn-style games, but with an explanation prompt after completion. LinkedIn's Queens, Tango, and Zip already illustrate distinct formats built around deduction and constraints. [3]
- **Decision dilemmas:** Choose between competing options with incomplete information—for example, selecting a credit-risk policy, travel plan, or product experiment.
- **Data detective:** Identify misleading charts, correlation-versus-causation errors, sampling bias, metric traps, or flawed conclusions.
- **Estimate and justify:** Make a reasonable numerical estimate, state assumptions, then compare against a transparent range.
- **AI reality check:** Review an AI-generated response and identify unsupported claims, missing information, ambiguity, or faulty logic.
- **Argument builder:** Turn a position into claim, evidence, assumption, counterargument, and final recommendation.

A sharper, investor-ready statement

Problem: Generative AI reduces the friction of finding answers, but it can also reduce the frequency with which people independently practise reasoning. Habitual, uncritical AI reliance may shift people from problem-solvers to answer-selectors, weakening confidence in their own judgment and increasing the risk of accepting plausible but flawed outputs.[4] [1]

Solution: StaySmart is a daily mental-gym platform that uses short, engaging games and real-world reasoning challenges to make active thinking a habit. It requires a user's attempt before help, provides feedback on the reasoning process, and teaches users to treat AI as a sparring partner and verifier—not a substitute for judgment.

Target user: Knowledge workers, students, and AI-heavy professionals—especially people who use ChatGPT, Copilot, Gemini, or workplace automation daily and want to retain strong independent thinking.

North-star metric: Percentage of daily challenges in which users submit an original rationale before accessing a hint or AI-assisted explanation.

A strong MVP would start with only three modes—**Logic Sprint, Data Detective, and AI Reality Check**—plus streaks, skill scores, and a weekly "reasoning report." The key product test is whether users return for the challenge *and* become better at explaining why they made a decision, rather than merely choosing the correct option.

Which audience should StaySmart serve first: AI-heavy professionals such as analysts and managers, university students, or a broader casual-puzzle audience?

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Refined target audience

StaySmart should focus first on **working professionals who use AI frequently**—analysts, managers, consultants, product teams, finance professionals, and knowledge workers. They already understand the value of staying sharp, but often work under time pressure, so the experience must be short, practical, and enjoyable rather than feel like schoolwork. Your core promise is:

> **StaySmart helps professionals keep their mental edge by practising fast calculation, structured reasoning, and AI judgment in just a few minutes a day.**

This positioning is stronger than "brain training." It connects the product to an important professional identity: *I can use AI productively, but I still know how to think, verify, decide, and explain.* Research on GenAI in work settings highlights that users may shift effort away from creating answers toward checking and integrating AI output; StaySmart can deliberately train that human oversight skill. [11]

The Super Math-style mode

Your childhood "Super Math" concept is an excellent **fast-entry game** because it is instantly understandable, measurable, and replayable. Call it **Number Sprint** or **QuickMath**.

Core game loop

1. User selects a mode: Addition, subtraction, multiplication, division, mixed operations, or percentage math.
2. A question appears with a simple response method:
    - Multiple-choice answers for beginner and casual modes.
    - Numeric keypad for intermediate and advanced modes.
    - Optional typed answer for desktop power users.
3. The user gets immediate feedback: correct/incorrect, current streak, accuracy, and average response time.
4. A 30-second round ends with a short scorecard.
5. The app offers a personal challenge: "Solve 50 correctly—how long can you take?"

Suggested modes

Mode	Experience	Skill being practised
30-Second Sprint	Solve as many as possible in 30 seconds	Speed and focus
50 Correct Challenge	Reach 50 correct answers as quickly as possible	Sustained accuracy
Accuracy Run	Finish 20 questions with minimal mistakes	Careful checking
Mixed Math	Random operations, percentages, ratios, discounts	Flexible numerical reasoning
Workday Numbers	Margin, tax, growth rate, conversions, percentages	Practical professional numeracy
Pressure Round	Harder questions with limited time and limited hints	Calm decision-making under time pressure

The reward should not be speed alone. Use a blended score such as:

$$\text{Score} = \text{Correct Answers} \times \text{Accuracy Multiplier} \times \text{Difficulty Multiplier}$$

That prevents users from randomly tapping answers just to increase volume.

Arithmetic training can improve speed and accuracy on arithmetic tasks, especially when practice includes feedback; however, evidence for broad improvements in unrelated cognitive abilities is limited. StaySmart should therefore avoid claiming that math games "raise intelligence" and instead promise measurable improvement in the specific skills users practise. [12] [13]

Guided answers without removing thinking

You are right that answers should be easy and guided. The design challenge is to lower friction **without turning the app into another AI answer machine.**

Use an adaptive ladder:

- **Level 1 — Recognition:** Multiple choice, with three plausible answers and one correct answer.
- **Level 2 — Guided calculation:** Show a partial step and ask the user to choose the next operation.
- **Level 3 — Independent answer:** The user enters the answer with a number pad.
- **Level 4 — Explain the choice:** For reasoning challenges, the user chooses a decision and one reason from a short list.
- **Level 5 — Defend the decision:** The user writes one or two sentences before seeing guidance or AI feedback.

For a percentage challenge, do not immediately show the full method. Start with: "A price rises from $80 to $100. Which change is correct?" Then offer choices. If incorrect, show one small corrective step, then ask a similar question. This is based on a sound learning pattern: attempt retrieval first, then receive feedback to correct errors and strengthen later recall. [14] [15]

Core product pillars

StaySmart should include three complementary tracks:

- **Speed:** Number Sprint, reaction games, pattern recognition, memory sequences.
- **Reasoning:** Logic puzzles, data interpretation, prioritization, trade-off decisions, and assumption-checking.
- **AI Judgment:** "Spot the flaw" challenges where the user evaluates an AI-style response for missing evidence, overconfidence, false assumptions, or poor reasoning.

This mix matters because LinkedIn-style puzzle formats create a familiar, low-friction habit, while workplace scenarios make the app relevant to professionals. LinkedIn's games already use short formats based on constraints, patterns, and logical deduction; StaySmart can borrow the accessibility of that model while adding practical decision practice. [16]

MVP problem statement

Professionals are adopting AI faster than they are building habits to preserve independent judgment. AI makes it easy to obtain a plausible answer, but frequent reliance without an initial personal attempt can reduce daily practice of calculation, reasoning, and verification. This leaves professionals vulnerable to accepting confident but flawed outputs and less confident in their own ability to make decisions.

StaySmart is a daily mental gym for working professionals. Through 3–7 minute guided challenges—including timed mental math, logic games, practical data scenarios, and AI-answer evaluation—it makes active thinking easy to start, rewarding to repeat, and measurable over

time. The app gives hints and answer choices when needed, but uses them to scaffold independent thinking rather than replace it.

Best MVP build

Start with just four features:

1. **Number Sprint:** 30-second and 50-correct arithmetic challenges.
2. **Daily Reasoning Challenge:** One short logic, estimation, or decision scenario.
3. **Guided learning engine:** Multiple-choice to independent-answer progression based on performance.
4. **Personal scorecard:** Accuracy, speed, streak, strongest skill, and one improvement area.

A useful first success metric is: **What percentage of weekly active users complete at least five daily challenges and improve either accuracy or median response time over four weeks?**

Which game should be the very first prototype: a 30-second mixed-math sprint, the 50-correct time trial, or a workplace percentage-and-finance challenge?

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Market notes

The daily “mental workout” format is already validated: **Elevate** provides adaptive daily training based on past performance, while **Lumosity** offers quick five-game workouts designed to take eight minutes or less. **Impulse** similarly combines personalized daily plans across mental math, attention, processing speed, and problem-solving; **Brilliant** differentiates through interactive, guided problem-solving rather than passive explanations. [23] [24] [25] [26]

The opportunity for StaySmart is not to copy generic brain training. Its positioning should be:

> **A 10-minute daily mental workout for AI-era professionals: sharpen calculation, reasoning, and judgment before outsourcing the work to AI.**

Unlike broad “brain training” products, StaySmart should centre professional-useful skills: mental arithmetic, interpreting data, prioritizing under constraints, logic, and checking AI-generated conclusions. Do not promise a higher IQ or universal cognitive improvement; measure and describe performance in the specific activities users practise. Existing products rely heavily on personalization, progressive difficulty, streaks, and performance reporting, so these are baseline expectations rather than unique differentiators. [27] [28] [29]

Daily workout design

Give users a default **10-minute SmartSet** containing three games; offer a five-game “Full Workout” for users with more time.

Workout	Time	Example game	Purpose
Quick SmartSet	8–10 min	3 games, ~3 min each	Daily habit for busy professionals

Workout	Time	Example game	Purpose
Full Workout	15 min	5 games, ~3 min each	More varied practice
Focus Workout	5 min	One chosen skill	Math, logic, data, or AI judgment
Recovery Workout	3 min	Easier game set	Maintains habit on busy days

A starter SmartSet could include:

1. **Number Sprint:** 30 seconds or 50-correct time trial; addition, subtraction, multiplication, percentages, and work-related calculations.
2. **Reasoning Round:** A logic, prioritization, or constraint puzzle.
3. **AI Check:** Review a short AI-style answer and select the missing assumption, misleading claim, unsupported conclusion, or best next verification step.

Users should always be able to swap one game, skip it without punishment, or select "more math" / "less math." Lumosity explicitly uses quick, favourite, and weakness-focused workout options, while Elevate's daily experience recommends training based on prior performance; those are useful interaction patterns to adapt. [24] [30]

Game and learning rules

Every game needs a common structure so the product feels cohesive:

- **Attempt first:** Show the challenge before any AI hint.
- **Guide, do not reveal:** Start with choices for novice users, then gradually require keypad or typed answers as confidence improves.
- **Instant feedback:** Explain one key reason after each answer, especially for mistakes.
- **Adaptive difficulty:** Increase complexity when a user is both accurate and fast; reduce difficulty or offer scaffolding after repeated errors.
- **Balanced scoring:** Reward accuracy, speed, consistency, and improvement—not speed alone.
- **Progress report:** Show weekly trends such as "Percentage reasoning: +12% accuracy" or "You paused before validating AI claims 4 times this week."

Guided, interactive problem solving with immediate feedback is a proven product pattern used by Brilliant, whose in-product tutor is designed to guide reasoning without simply exposing the answer. [31] [26]

Recommended MVP scope

Build only **five games** initially, all powered by configurable question banks rather than separate custom game engines:

1. **Number Sprint** — timed arithmetic and percentage calculations.
2. **50 Correct** — speed-to-accuracy challenge.
3. **Logic Grid Lite** — short deduction puzzle with guided choices.

4. **Data Detective** — select the sound conclusion from a chart, table, or business scenario.
5. **AI Reality Check** — identify what must be checked before acting on an AI recommendation.

The first version needs:

- Sign-in, onboarding assessment, and selectable professional goal.
- A daily scheduler that assembles 3 or 5-game workouts.
- A game configuration system: question, answer options, correct answer, difficulty, skill tags, explanations, time limit, and hint.
- Adaptive difficulty and simple personalization rules.
- Streaks, badges, scorecards, and weekly performance summaries.
- Push notifications on mobile and browser reminders on web.
- Admin tools for adding questions, reviewing content, and viewing game quality metrics.

Architecture recommendation

Use **Expo + React Native + TypeScript** for one shared codebase across iOS, Android, and web. Expo officially supports building Android, iOS, and web apps from a single codebase, which reduces cost and keeps game rules and user progress consistent across devices. [32] [33]

Layer	Recommended choice	Why it fits StaySmart
Client apps	Expo, React Native, TypeScript	Shared mobile and web codebase; rapid MVP delivery
Web deployment	Expo web deployment	Web companion with the same core app logic
Backend	Supabase	Authentication, PostgreSQL, APIs, storage, and real-time features
Database	PostgreSQL via Supabase	Reliable relational model for users, games, attempts, schedules, and scores
Authentication	Supabase Auth	Email/password, Google, Apple, and secure sessions
Server logic	Supabase Edge Functions	Generate daily workouts, calculate scores, create reports, send AI requests securely
Content system	Admin web portal + database-backed game definitions	Add new questions without releasing the mobile app
AI layer	LLM API behind server functions	Generate feedback or explanations only after a user attempt
Notifications	Expo Notifications plus email provider later	Daily reminders and streak nudges
Analytics	PostHog or Amplitude	Funnel, retention, game difficulty, and learning-behaviour analysis
Payments	Stripe + App Store / Google Play billing	Web and mobile subscription handling

Supabase’s database security model supports Row Level Security, so each user can be restricted to their own scores, workout history, and profile data; this should be enabled on all exposed

user-data tables. Supabase Realtime is optional for the MVP but can later support live leaderboards, friend challenges, and event updates.[34] [35]

Core data model

```
users
profiles
skills
games
game_versions
questions
question_options
daily_workouts
daily_workout_items
game_attempts
attempt_answers
skill_ratings
streaks
achievements
weekly_reports
content_review_queue
```

The most important design choice is to store games as **content plus rules**, not hard-coded screens. For example, every Number Sprint question can be a row with operands, operation, answer, time target, skill tags, and difficulty. This lets you expand from basic arithmetic to business math, percentages, and estimation without rebuilding the application.

Architecture prompt

Use this prompt when you are ready to ask an AI coding agent or engineering team to create the MVP:

```
Build StaySmart, a cross-platform daily mental-workout app for working professionals

Product goal:
Help professionals maintain calculation speed, independent reasoning, and AI judgmen

Platforms:
Build a responsive web app plus iOS and Android apps from one TypeScript codebase usi

MVP experience:
1. User signs up with email, Google, or Apple.
2. User completes a short baseline assessment for math, logic, data reasoning, and AI
3. Each day, the Today screen shows a SmartSet of three games, estimated at 8-10 minu
4. Users can choose Full Workout with five games or replace one recommended game.
5. After each game, show score, accuracy, response time, explanation, and one improve
6. After all games, show workout completion, streak, skill updates, and a short summa
7. Users can view history, skill trends, achievements, and weekly reports.

Initial games:
- Number Sprint: solve as many arithmetic questions as possible in 30 seconds.
- 50 Correct: solve 50 questions accurately in the fastest time.
```

```
- Logic Grid Lite: short deduction questions with multiple-choice guided steps.
- Data Detective: identify valid conclusions, misleading metrics, and appropriate nex
- AI Reality Check: assess an AI-style response and identify unsupported claims, miss

Learning and personalization rules:
- Require an answer before users can use a hint or explanation.
- Start new users with multiple-choice options.
- Progress capable users to numeric keypad or typed answers.
- Adapt difficulty using accuracy, median response time, recent trend, and repeated-e
- Balance workouts across skills and target one weaker area without making every acti
- Never claim IQ improvement or medical cognitive benefits.
- AI feedback must be supportive, short, explain the reasoning, and never provide the

Technical architecture:
- Expo + React Native + TypeScript for iOS, Android, and web.
- Supabase for Auth, PostgreSQL, Storage, Edge Functions, and Row Level Security.
- Use database-driven game content; do not hard-code questions into screens.
- Build a lightweight admin web portal for creating, reviewing, publishing, versionin
- Use server-side functions to generate daily workouts, calculate scores, update skil
- Add PostHog or Amplitude analytics for onboarding completion, daily active users, w
- Use Expo push notifications and web reminders, with notification preferences and qu
- Design for accessibility: keyboard navigation on web, screen-reader labels, scalabl

Key database entities:
profiles, skills, games, game_versions, questions, question_options, daily_workouts,

Security:
Enable Row Level Security for every user-data table. A user can only read and modify

Deliverables:
- A clean mobile-first UI with Today, Play, Progress, Profile, and Admin areas.
- Database schema and migration files.
- Seed data with at least 50 questions per initial game.
- Unit tests for scoring and difficulty logic.
- End-to-end test for sign-up, daily workout completion, cross-device progress sync,
- Clear README with local setup, environment variables, deployment steps, and archite
```

Before turning this into code, decide the **first 3-game SmartSet**: which three games best represent the StaySmart promise to a busy professional, and why?

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